TIME · GROUPS AND UPBEATS · LEARN

Groups and upbeats

REMEMBER Beams show the beats: they join the notes of one beat, or in 4/4 of beats 1–2 or 3–4, never across the middle.

1 Good grouping?

★★☆

Circle ✓ if the grouping shows the beats, × if it hides one. The first is done.



(✓) ×



✓ ×



✓ ×



✓ ×

2 Cut the beat

★☆☆

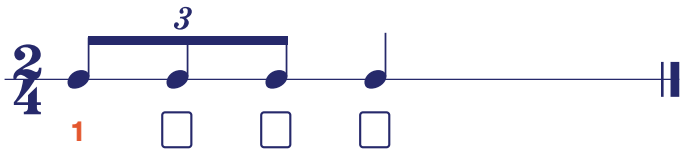
One beat is one pizza. Colour each one, then write how much of a beat each note gets and how you count it. The first is done.

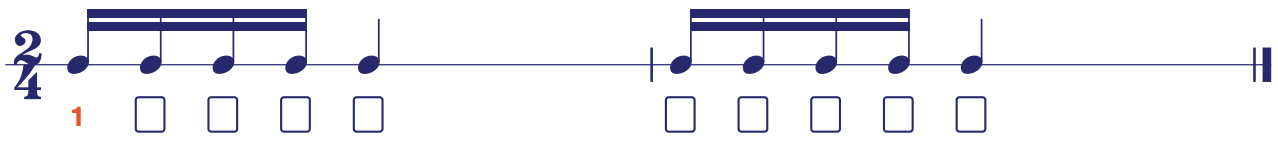
two quavers		half a beat each	1 &
a triplet		_____	_____
four semiquavers		_____	_____

3 Count it

★★☆

Write a count in every box: a triplet (1 & a), then semiquavers (1 e & a). The first of each is done.





Date _____

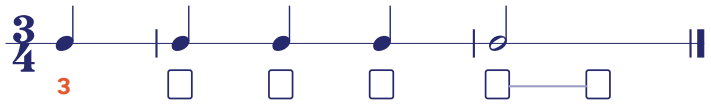
TIME · GROUPS AND UPBEATS · USE

Groups and upbeats

REMEMBER An upbeat and the last bar together make one full bar.

1 The upbeat ★★☆

This piece starts on beat 3 (done for you). Write a count in every other box. Then: how many beats does the last bar need?



beats in the last bar ☐

2 Clap the upbeat ★☆☆

Clap the piece in exercise 1 with a metronome: count “1 2” silently, clap on 3. Tick a circle each time the last bar is exactly two beats.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

3 Clap and count ★★☆

Triplets and semiquavers: clap with a metronome while counting aloud. Tick a circle each day it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

4 In your music ★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
an upbeat (anacrusis)		
a triplet		
four semiquavers in one beat		

Date _____